coursera | MoMA

Modern Art & Ideas ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas

Module 2
Places & Spaces

Introduction to Places & Spaces
✓ Welcome to Module 2 Reading • 10 min
✓ Places & Spaces Video • 4 min

Real and Imaginary Places
✓ How do artists choose to represent the world? Reading • 20 min
✓ Martin Wong. Stanton near Forsyth Street. 1983 Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Zarina. Home is a Foreign Place. 1999 Video • 2 min

Experiencing a Place
✓ How do artists capture the mood of a place? Reading • 10 min
✓ Claude Monet. Water Lilies. 1914-26 Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Emeka Ogboh. Lagos State of Mind. 2017/2020 Video • 2 min

Reimagining a Place
✓ How do artists reimagine architecture? Reading • 10 min
✓ Teddy Cruz, Fonna Forman. Manufactured Sites: A Housing Urbanism Made of Waste/Maquiladora, project (Model, 2005). 2005-2008 Video • 2 min
✓ Carolina Caycedo. Spirals for Shared Dreams. 2022 Video • 4 min

Review & Reflect
✓ Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min
✓ Assessment: Places & Spaces Dialogue • 15 min
✓ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Art & Identity

Introduction to Art & Identity
✓ Welcome to Module 3 Reading • 10 min
✓ Art & Identity Video • 4 min

Identity & Portraiture
✓ How do artists represent their sense of self? Reading • 20 min
✓ Henri Matisse. The Red Studio. 1911 Video • 2 min
✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Frida Kahlo. Self-Portrait with Cropped Hair. 1940 Video • 1 min

Identity & Relationships
○ **How do artists represent others?** Reading • 10 min
○ Catherine Opie. Being and Having. 1991 Video • 1 min
○ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
○ Amira Virgil. The Melanin Pack for The Sims 4. 2016 Video • 2 min

Challenging Identity
○ How do artists challenge identity? Reading • 10 min
○ Lorna Simpson. Wigs (Portfolio). 1994 Video • 2 min
○ Kay WalkingStick. You're an Indian? 1995 Video • 1 min

Review & Reflect
○ Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min
○ Assessment: Art & Identity Dialogue • 15 min
○ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection Reading • 10 min
○ Optional Mid-Course Survey Reading • 5 min

Module 4
Transforming Everyday Objects

Module 5
Module 5: Art & Society

Module 6
Course Conclusion

How do artists represent others?

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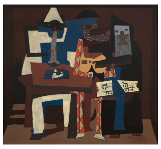
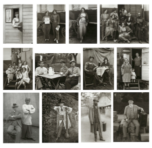


Pablo Picasso. *Three Musicians*. 1921. Oil on canvas, 6' 7" x 7' 3 3/4" (200.7 x 222.9 cm). Gift of Mrs. Simon Guggenheim. © 2016 Estate of Pablo Picasso/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

This intricate, jigsaw-puzzle-like composition features variations on stock characters from the Italian comic theater tradition known as commedia dell'arte. Picasso designed the sets and the costumes for two ballets performed in Paris in the six months before he left for vacation in Fontainebleu, where he painted *Three Musicians*.

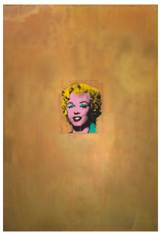
Notions of performance, stage, scale, and working big must have been on his mind. At left, a masked Pierrot plays the clarinet and strumming a guitar at center is Harlequin, a figure Picasso often treats as a stand-in for himself. They are joined by, at right, a monk holding sheet music and, hiding below the table, an outstretched dog.



August Sander. *People of the Twentieth Century. The City. Traveling People: Fair and Circus*. 1926-32. Gelatin silver prints, each approx. 10 × 7" (25.4 × 17.8 cm) or the reverse. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of the family of August Sander © 2016 Die Photographische Sammlung / SK Stiftung Kultur - August Sander Archiv, Cologne / ARS, NY

If you were to take a portrait of every "type" of person that exists today, how many portraits would you need to take? If you grouped all of the portraits together into a series, what would it look like? How would you define and categorize these "types"? Where would you start? German photographer August Sander was likely considering these questions in the mid-1920s, when he began his decades-long project *People of the Twentieth Century*. Though Sander never completed this ambitious project, it includes over 600 photographs divided into seven volumes and nearly 50 portfolios. The seven volumes Sander used as his organizing principles were The Farmer, The Skilled Tradesman, The Woman, Classes and Professions, The Artists, The City, and The Last People.

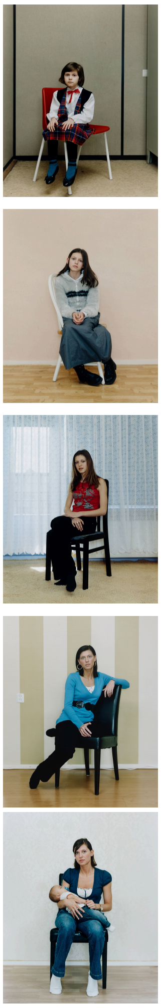
Though the people who posed for Sander are presented as types, he carefully aligned his designations with the way his subjects identified themselves. "The individual does not make the history of his time, but he both impresses himself on it and expresses its meaning," Sander explained.



Andy Warhol. *Gold Marilyn*. 1962. Silkscreen ink on synthetic polymer paint on canvas, 6' 11 1/4" x 57" (211.4 x 144.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Philip Johnson. © 2016 Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

In 1962, America was shocked by the news that actress and pop culture icon Marilyn Monroe had died of a drug overdose. Andy Warhol soon immortalized her in *Gold Marilyn*. He took a cropped image of her head from a 1953 publicity photograph from the film *Niagara*, and silkscreened it onto the center of a large canvas coated with gold paint. Her yellow hair and lavender face floats in this gold field, overlaid with slightly-off register red lipstick and turquoise eye shadow.

In this composition, Warhol collapses the tradition of Byzantine icon painting with the techniques of commercial advertising, suggesting that Monroe was a modern-day goddess created and commodified both by Hollywood and the viewing public. She personified American beauty, prosperity, and happiness, but the construction of this idealized image came at the expense of her experiences with anxiety and depression. As Warhol once observed: "Everyone needs a fantasy."



Rineke Dijkstra. *Almerisa* series. 1994–2008. Chromogenic color print, 13 3/4 x 11" (35 x 28 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Horace W. Goldsmith Fund through Robert B. Menschel. © 2016 Rineke Dijkstra

Rineke Dijkstra was photographing Bosnian refugee children at an asylum center in the Netherlands, where she encountered and photographed six-year-old Almerisa Sehric. Revisiting this photograph two years later, Dijkstra was struck by its power. She sought out Almerisa and her family, who were by then living in their own apartment. And so began a sustained portrait series, for which Dijkstra photographed Almerisa every two years.

"What you see in this series is…how she develops from a child from a foreign country into a Dutch young woman," describes Dijkstra. "The chair represents my life […]," says Almerisa, referring to the increasingly solid chairs in which she is seated in every picture. "When I came to the Netherlands it was…unstable like the plastic chair, and now I'm sitting on a wooden chair with more stability, with my feet on the ground and holding my first-born child."

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